



Chapter 12: Resume Improvement Examples

This section is a collection of real resumes that you can use as inspiration when writing yours.

Remember that your resume should be about *your* experience, tailored for the *specific* position you are applying for.

I started writing this book after offering to review resumes for software developers who were looking for jobs. Having received too many requests for me to review in-depth, I started to send an early version of this book as feedback for people—this book was at 30 pages, so much shorter than it is today!

The below examples are real resumes that I received. They were often ones where the author was not receiving the type of response rate they were hoping for. You'll read the initial analysis of the resume, then see the improved version that the author ended up using as their "master" resume.

All examples are anonymized: names of people, companies, schools, locations and dates have been altered to not allow tracking back to the original author. The other features of the resume are as they were—giving you an idea of some typical areas that you could also address with your current resume.

Resist copying anything one-for-one from these examples. These resumes are someone else's experience. Use these to get inspiration, and see if your resume has similar improvement opportunities.

Software Engineer with 2 Years Experience

The below resume is one for a person with a few years' experience, who intended to apply for Facebook's Rotational Engineering Program. Here is the description of the position, and the requirement details:

Facebook's Rotational Engineering Program

Facebook is seeking talented full-stack Software Engineers who would like an opportunity to join our one-year Rotational Engineering Program, helping us build applications & systems that will scale the company and make the world more open and connected. The Program is designed to offer experienced engineers a one-year rotation through different Facebook engineering departments to develop engineering skills and gain meaningful experience for the rest of their career. At the end of the term, successful participants will be invited to apply for a full-time position at the company. Facebook is committed to increasing the diversity of representation among our Computer Scientists and Software Engineers.

rotational engineering program is open to all qualified candidates. We strongly encourage candidates who are members of historically underrepresented groups and have non-traditional career paths to apply, including, but not limited to candidates from non-tech industries, candidates without Computer Science degrees who are self-taught, candidates starting second careers, re-entering the workforce, and those who have attended bootcamp-style programming courses.

Rotational Software Engineer Responsibilities

- Full-stack product/systems development with a variety of languages such as C++, Java, PHP, JavaScript, etc.
- Work closely with product management and UX design teams to define and refine feature specifications.
- Design and develop front-end interfaces, underlying APIs, and backend systems across a number of programming languages with focus on JavaScript, React and PHP (Hack).
- Learn, learn and learn.

Minimum Qualifications

- 2+ years experience building software solutions in a corporate or startup engineering environment, or equivalent, using JavaScript, PHP, Python, Ruby, C++ and/or Java.
- 2+ years experience developing web applications.

Preferred Qualifications

- Bachelor's degree in Computer Science/Math/Engineering, or equivalent educational experience.
- Working knowledge of relational and non-relational databases and SQL.
- Working knowledge of API design and distributed backend systems.
- 2+ years' experience developing multi-tiered web apps.

The original resume

E-Mail: edmondsmith88@example.com
 Website: <https://EdmondSmithDev.github.io/>

TECH STACKS

- Programming Languages/Frameworks: PHP/Laravel, JavaScript/Express, Java/Kotlin for Android
- Database: Postgres, MySQL, MongoDB
- Infrastructure: AWS
- Testing Tools: , PHPUnit, Mockery
- API Specs: REST

WORK EXPERIENCE

Cloudless, Backend Software Engineer(Remote) Sep 2018 – present

- Re-architected and maintaining a RESTful API using PHP/Laravel with third-party API integrations such as zoom-rooms to enrich customer experience.

MennoMark, Team Lead Sep 2017 – Aug 2018

- Managed a team of three developers on the development team.
- Trained and on-board two new software developers on the software products(MennoMarker, MennoMarket).
- Acted in leadership capacity and worked together with the rest of the development team to deliver quality software.
- Built a mobile app(MennoInnova) for educating farmers enrolled in the Farmer Business Management programme. This was built with Kotlin, and SQLite Database.
- Designed and implemented an API for interfacing the MennoInnova mobile application using PHP/Lumen, AWS(RDS, Elasticbeanstalk), PostMan.

MennoMark, Software Developer - Jan 2018 – Mar 2018

- Built an internal mobile app(MennoMini) for recording biometric data of poultry farmers in South Africa. This was built with Java, and SQLite Database.
- Designed and implemented an API for interfacing the MennoMini mobile application using PHP/Lumen, AWS(RDS, Elasticbeanstalk), PostMan.

South Business School, BootCamp Trainer and Curriculum Developer Aug 2017

- Designed an android application development curriculum with focus on Java for the bootcamp.
- Trained the participants with zero programming background to have a good understanding of Java and developed sample Android Application in a month.

AdvancedLearning, Technical Writer Mar 2017

- Updated previous technical articles to meet new features in JavaScript like classes.
- Researched and wrote an article on building software with Angular which was ranked among the top ten articles for Angular in June 2018.

Loud Fort, Software Developer Intern Jun 2016 - Aug 2016

- Implemented API Designs in Golang programming language.
- Documented APIs in Swagger(API Documentation and Designing tool).
- Trained three interns on how to work with the Go Programming Language.

The Trace Foundation, Software Developer Intern May 2015 - Aug 2015

- Built an interface for a web application with HTML, CSS, Material Design and JavaScript(Angular).
- Learned about backend development with the Go programming language.

present

- Managing an online user group for software developers.
- Organizing meetups, workshops and hackathons for software developers in Cape Town.
- Building partnerships with local tech companies and communities like [JSKongress](#) to support the growth of the developer ecosystem.

[Cape Town Tech Meetups](#), Technical Speaker

Aug 2017

- Gave a talk on building microservices with Java Spring Boot.

EDUCATION

[Cape Town University](#) – Cape Town, South Africa

Sep 2013 – Jun 2017

- Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

AWARDS AND ACHIEVEMENTS

- [Developer Community Work Spotlight](#) - AdvancedLearning Dec 2018
- [MasterCard Foundation Scholar](#) – Cape Town University 2013 – 2017

SKILLS AND INTERESTS

- Experience with architecture and design principles, building to consider maintainability, performance, security requirements, and impact.
- Experience working with software engineering collaboration tools like Git, Trello, Slack.
- Working knowledge of Object-Oriented Programming concepts i.e Classes and objects, Inheritance, Encapsulation, and Polymorphism
- Interested in developer community-building by hosting meetups, speaking at tech programs and technical writing.
- Experience working with Front End Technologies(HTML, CSS, JavaScript)
- Experience working with Front End Javascript Frameworks: Angular
- Experience with Front End Debugging Tools: Chrome DevTool

PERSONAL PROJECTS

[bareGo](#)

This project is usually for learning about software architecture and design using the PHP programming language. The concepts such as SOLID, Design patterns, etc, are applicable to other programming languages.

[RESTAPI with Node](#)

Implementation of modern API design principles and concepts with Nodejs. Concepts include HATEOAS, Caching, Content Negotiation, etc.

[Technical Writing](#)

I write about technical concepts that I learn about or find useful to the developer ecosystem on the Dev.to blogging platform.

Analysis of the resume

Overall, this is not a bad resume—but there are many improvements that could make it a much stronger one for this position.

The good

- **Good amount of personal details.** This resume doesn't share too many unnecessary personal details.
- **A decent template and usage of bullet points.** The template helps with good usage of space, and bullet points make it easy to read the statements.

Improvement areas

- **Overly generous spacing.** The margins on the sides of the resume were unusually large—reducing the space of what would fit on each of the pages. While good spacing can benefit resumes, there is no reason to have very large spacing on the top and the side.
- **Consistency.** Formatting is not consistent, and it brings a sloppy feel for the resume. Font sizes and alignment are different in different sections.
- **Drawing focus to the wrong thing.** This resume has many links—the person linked to all their previous companies. When glancing at the resume, the recruiter's attention is immediately drawn to the names of companies. However, it would be smarter to draw attention to the title of the engineer and the date. A different template could help with this, as would toning down link colors.
- **The impact of the work.** Within the work experience, there could be more specific impact mentioned about the person's work. There are some specifics, but there are also a lot of phrases like "Built a mobile app", without explaining what was impactful, challenging or interesting about it.
- **Linking to company websites.** The links to company websites drew attention but brought little value. If a recruiter or hiring manager wants to look up the company, they can do so without a link, just by searching for the company name. Besides, the company landing page does not convey much relevant information.
- **Splitting out a 3-month position at MennoMark.** This person got promoted after a few months at MennoMark. They decided to split this 3-month-long position out into separate sections. Because of how fast this promotion was, they could just ignore this short position, not mentioning it.

The refactored resume

Cape Town, South Africa edmondsmith88@example.com

[Website](#)

TECHNOLOGIES AND LANGUAGES

- PHP, JavaScript, Java, Kotlin, Android, Angular, Laravel, Express.js, Ktor
- MySQL, MongoDB, AWS, Git
- Data structures and algorithms, API design, engineering best practices, unit testing

WORK EXPERIENCE

Backend Software Engineer **Cloudless** **Sep 2018 – present**
Remote

- Improved customer conversion by 30% of the Whack co-working platform by implementing recurring payments and integrating Zoom rooms.
- Re-architected the restful API powering the mobile client for Whack, using PHP and Laravel.

Development Team Lead **MennoMark** **Jan 2017 – Aug 2018**

- Led a team of 3 engineers to ship multiple apps and services.
- Built an app for educating cocoa farmers enrolled in the Farmer Business School programme, using Kotlin and Room database.
- Designed and built a mobile app to record biometric data of poultry farmers in South Africa, using Java, and SQLite database.
- Designed and implemented APIs that powered our 10 mobile applications using PHP, Lumen, Laravel, AWS RDS, AWS Elasticbeanstalk and PostMan.
- Onboarded and trained 6 new employees on the company's development and product stack.

Developer and Trainer **South Business School** **Summer 2017**

- Designed an month-long Android application development bootcamp curriculum with 30 modules and a strong Java focus.
- Trained 40 participants from zero programming background to having a good working knowledge of Java, and being able to build Android applications in a month.

Guest Author **AdvancedLearning** **Summer 2017**

- Researched and wrote an article on building software with Angular Material UI which was ranked among the top ten articles for Angular in June 2018.
- Reworked technical articles, updating them to reflect ES6, ES7 and ES8 Javascript features

Software Developer Intern **Loud Fort** **Summer 2017**

- Built an internal web tool to manage leads more efficiently, used by 30 sales people. Built using JavaScript, Angular, Go, HTML and CSS.

EDUCATION

Cape Town University **2013 - 2017**

- Bachelor of Science in Computer Science
- Received the MasterCard Foundation Scholar, awarded to 10 out of 300 applicants.

organizing 30+ events and hackathons. Featured on the [Community Storytellers' Series](#).

- **BareGo** - A minimal and progressive PHP framework for building efficient and scalable server-side applications. See the source [on Github](#).
- **REST API with Node** - Modern API design principles and concepts with Nodejs. Concepts include HATEOAS, Caching and Content Negotiation. See the source [on Github](#).
- **Technical blogging** on [Dev.to](#) and as guest publisher. Popular articles include a piece [on Angular Material](#) and one [on Clean Code](#).

Analysis of the refactored resume

The refactored resume addressed most of the improvements we previously mentioned. A few things to call out with this improved resume are:

- **Tailored for the position the person is applying for.** For example, the position mentioned languages like C++, Java, PHP, JavaScript etc. As the person is hands-on with PHP and JavaScript, the resume lists these first.
- **Impact and what this person actively did comes across more clearly.** The updated resume uses active language and showcases specific examples of impact. Note how this is exactly the same person, talking about exactly the same work they have done. In the updated version, however, they have gone deeper to express how their work was important beyond just coding.
- **More concise wording, with just as much details.** The two resumes convey roughly the same amount of information. However, in the second one, much of the irrelevant or repetitive information has been cut.
- **More deliberate guiding of the reader's focus.** In the original resume, links were scattered. Take the technical blogging section: in the original resume, this was just a link to the Dev.to page of this engineer. Now, instead of linking to a blog, this person calls out two articles they'd like the hiring manager to glance at. This is a much more focused approach.

Ways this resume could be made even better:

- **A short summary section** is something I'd consider adding, especially if there's information this candidate can reflect on for the job description. For example, the job description says: *"We strongly encourage candidates who are members of historically underrepresented groups and have non-traditional career paths to apply, including, but not limited to candidates from non-tech industries, candidates without Computer Science degrees who are self-taught, candidates starting second careers to apply."* If some of this applies to the candidate, I'd encourage them to reflect on this in this section.
- **Tailor the resume to other positions**, over using this one as a "one-size-fits-all" one.

Machine Learning Engineer with 5 Years Experience

After refactoring the resume to a 1-pager one below, they saw a lot more leads, including from companies that they did not hear back from before. The person ended up landing a job at one of the companies they were targeting.

The original resume

PAT THOMPSON
MACHINE LEARNING ENGINEER @
LASTMINUTE.COM LTD

Location: Vienna, Austria
Github: https://github.com/pat_t
LinkedIn: https://www.linkedin.com/in/pat_t
Email: pat_t@icloud.com
Site: https://pat_t.dev/

EXPERIENCE

Machine Learning Engineer
Lastminute.com, Vienna, Austria
2018 – current – Full-time

Backend Python Developer
CARRS, Vienna, Austria
2016 – 2018 – Full-time

Software Developer
Lending Limited LP, San Mateo, CA, US
2015 – 2016 – Full-time (remote)

Machine Learning Developer
Inno Systems, San Mateo, CA, US
2015 – 2015 – Contract (remote)

Founder & Software Engineer
Future Co, Sao Paulo, Brazil
2014 – 2015 – Full-time

FRAMEWORKS & LIBRARIES

Machine Learning:
Tensorflow, Spacy, NLTK,
Sklearn, OpenCV

Web:
Django, Flask, Vuejs, Nodejs,
Phoenix

Data Processing:
Spark, Pandas, Numpy

Other:
Selenium, beautifulsoup4, Click

EDUCATION

B. S. of Computer Science • 2015
University of São Paulo, Brazil

PROGRAMMING LANGUAGES

Python	● ● ● ● ●
Javascript	● ● ● ● ●
Elixir	● ● ● ● ●
Go	● ● ● ● ●
Kotlin	● ● ● ● ●

CLOUD

AWS:
EC2, RDS, EMR, ECS, SageMaker,
S3

TOOLS

Docker, Terraform, Packer,
PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB
Snowflake, Airflow, Jenkins,
Kubernetes, Nvidia, CUDA

DESIGN PATTERNS

REST, MVC, Microservices, TDD,
Server-Side-Rendering

Machine Learning Engineer

Lastminute.com, Vienna, Austria

2018 – current – Full-time

Lastminute.com is one of the largest websites in the world that runs best-in-market flash sales of hotels and holidays. It operates in 21 countries and offer its members exclusive rates of up to 60% off!

As a Machine Learning Software Engineer I bring in my technical development expertise and knowledge to Data Science team. My main purpose is to support the business by utilizing data science solutions and building production-ready data products.

Things I work on:

- Implementing and optimising data pipelines, monitoring and alerting, etc to ensure data flows correctly into models;
- Help build up tooling and infrastructure for Data Science team for model deployment, management and performance monitoring;
- Facilitate integration of work from Data Science team into production environments by scoping and defining interfaces with production environment;
- Provide technical best practice to team;
- Set up standardised libraries of tooling for data manipulation, models, etc to improve speed of development for data scientists;
- Liaise with key stakeholders Engineering and Data teams
- Keep myself updated on new developments in your field of expertise.

Stack: Python, Flask, Docker, Terraform, Git, AWS, Tensorflow, NLTK, Spark, RESTful APIs, Snowflake, Postgres, Airflow, CUDA+Nvidia (for GPU intensive processes).

Backend Python Developer

CARRS, Vienna, Austria

2016 – 2018 – Full-time

CARRS is a leading car trading platform. By connecting buyers and sellers across through technology, CARRS enables private customers as well as professional partners to trade seamlessly.

Here I was responsible for:

- Build, test and maintain innovative tools to automate the company's internal processes within the marketing department;
- Implement high performance and complex algorithm-based solution;
- Perform data analysis on databases using machine learning algorithms;
- Implement algorithms to perform text classification and sentiment analysis.

Stack: Python, Flask, RESTful APIs, SQL, ORM libs, Docker, AWS, Git, Microservices, Keras/SKLearn (Machine Learning), NLTK/Spacy (Sentiment Analysis).

2015 – 2016 – Full-time (remote)

Lending Limited is a private direct lender to fix-and-flip investors and the first a fund with more than \$100M in loans in a single year — There I was responsible for developing (in a test driven approach) new features and maintaining the company's internal micro-services and web apps used to handle all of its business processes.

Stack: Python, Pyramid, Django, HTML/CSS/JavaScript, MongoDB, AWS, Git, Mercurial, Microservices, Docker, Go.

Machine Learning Developer

Inno Systems, San Mateo, CA, US

2015 – 2015 – Contract (remote)

Inno Systems' primary mission is to provide practical solutions for real-world business problems using deep learning and machine learning solutions. There I was responsible for developing Machine Learning algorithms exploring several of its subfields concepts such as Data Mining, Text Classification but mainly Computer Vision in a Game Theory project.

Stack: Python, C++, OpenCV, Sklearn, Pandas, Numpy, Git, AWS, NLTK.

Founder & Software Engineer

Future Co, Sao Paulo, Brazil

2014 – 2015 – Full-time

Future Co. was a software factory type of company which I founded during my last year in university. Our goal was to provide software solutions to small local business in the city where I studied. Besides managing the business as whole, I also acted as a Software Engineer designing, developing and testing our applications for a diverse client base.

Stack: Python, Java, Django, HTML5/CSS3/JavaScript, Nginx, JSON, Postgresql, MySQL, AWS, DigitalOcean, Git.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION**LANGUAGES**

Portuguese ● ● ● ● ●

English ● ● ● ● ●

Spanish ● ● ● ● ●

Italian ● ● ● ● ●

German ● ● ● ● ●

TALKS

Scanning the Web with Python.

2014 – II Python Beach, Brazil

Intro to Python multi-platform framework for Apps Development.

2013 – I Python Beach, Brazil

Analysis of the resume

The resume is an instant turn-off. The template is unnecessarily hard to read. The first page feels like it was written just to have buzzwords on it. Also, it immediately tells the story of someone who is either not a good developer or just overly modest. Why would the resume start with this person rating themselves as 4/5 on Python, 3/5 on Javascript?

managers likely never got here, and moved this resume to the “reject” pile after scanning the first page.

Improvement areas

- **Use an easy to read template.** The current template makes it hard to scan the resume contents. The black headers draw attention needlessly.
- **Do not use the skills self-rating.** As discussed in the [Unnecessary Details section](#), self-rating skills proficiency can only work against you on a resume. This can be seen here, in action. As a hiring manager, I could assume this person is not a good developer, based on their own rating. If they rate their Javascript as 3/5, some hiring managers could assume they are not quite proficient—which is not at all what this person wanted to convey.
- **Talk about impact and results**, not what you were told to do. In a new field like machine learning, most companies will look for people who take the initiative and get results.
- **Convey the right type of information on the first page.** This person has a lot to build on: so do this. They should showcase the impactful work they've done, and their skills.
- **Talk more about themselves, not their companies.** For every position listed, this person writes nearly as much about the company as they do for their achievements. Drop the part on the company: they should focus on their results.
- **Use bullet points** for easier reading. Much of the resume has paragraphs that list different pieces of information. For example, the first sentence talks about the company and the second one about their achievements. After reading the first sentence, the person scanning the resume would skip to the next paragraph, assuming that a paragraph talks about the same topic.

The refactored resume

Vienna, Austria	github.com/pat_t linkedin.com/in/pat_t	pat_t@icloud.com
EMPLOYMENT		
Machine Learning Engineer	Lastminute.com – Vienna, Austria	2018 – current
• Created infrastructure needed for development, staging, and production within the Data Science pipeline. • Reduced 50% of costs on cloud hosting by building an in-house scaling tool to manage cloud resources. • Improved the speed of Spark clustering algorithms whilst reducing the cost by building the infrastructure to use AWS EMR (Elastic Map Reduce). • Built and exposed APIs for model prediction in real-time. • Created custom Tensorflow Docker image to use it in AWS Sagemaker. • Created continuous integration and deployment pipeline.		
Backend Engineer	CARRS – Vienna, Austria	2016 – 2018
• Built software tools to interact and automate several different online marketing services such as Google Ads, Facebook, and Instagram. • Developed a sentiment analysis model to evaluate and tag customer feedback, saving hours of manual labor. • Built and exposed APIs to serve predictions. • Created a full-stack web application for internal stakeholders. • Built infrastructure for deployment on AWS using Terraform.		
Software Engineer	Lending Limited – San Mateo, CA, US (Remote)	2015 – 2016
• Built several microservices for the main product. • Developed automation tool for document generation. • Created a full-stack web application for the company's blog.		
Machine Learning Engineer (Contract)	Inno Systems – San Mateo, CA, US (Remote)	2015 – 2015
• Designed and developed a Computer Vision algorithm to detect dices and player moves in a video stream. • Created infrastructure for local development using tools such as Docker.		
Founder & Software Engineer	Future Co. – Sao Paulo, Brazil	2014 – 2015
• Founded the software factory company during the last year of university. • Designed, developed, and productionised software for several customers. • Led a team of 4 people: 3 developers and 1 product designer. • Interacted and gathered feedback from clients and stakeholders.		
EDUCATION		
Sao Paulo, Brazil B.S. of Computer Science	University of Sao Paulo	2011 – 2015
TECHNOLOGIES		
Programming Languages	Frameworks & Libraries	Tools
Python, Javascript, Elixir, Go, SQL	Django, Flask, Vuejs, Nodejs, Phoenix, Tensorflow, Spacy, NLTK, Sklearn, OpenCV, Selenium, beautifulsoup4, Click, Spark, Pandas, Numpy.	AWS, Docker, Terraform, Packer, PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Snowflake, Airflow, Jenkins, Kubernetes, Nvidia, CUDA.

Analysis of the refactored resume

The difference between the original and the refactored resume is striking. The resume is down to one page, is a lot easier to read and conveys the applicant's experience much better. The person applied much of the advice in this book.

They also saw a lot more leads, including from companies that they did not hear back from before. The person ended up landing a job at one of these companies.

a full-stack web application for internal stakeholders", they could say "Created a full-stack web application for internal stakeholders using Vue.js Django, deploying it on AWS."

- **Use numbers** when describing the work experience. E.g. instead of *"Created a full-stack web application for internal stakeholders"*, list specifics like *"Designed, implemented and deployed 4 microservices for the main product. These services serve 100 RPS."*

Backend Developer with 6 Years Experience

This example is from a backend engineer who spent a few years working at a company building payroll software. They originally intended to use their resume to apply to similar, but larger companies.

With their original resume, they were seeing far less response than they were hoping for. With the improvements, they noticed a considerably higher rate of callbacks, and ended up accepting an offer for a local startup for a senior engineer position.

The original resume

Software Developer

Email: nikita.pratley@gmail.comLinkedIn: [in/nikitapratley](https://www.linkedin.com/in/nikitapratley)

Technical Skills

Java, SQL, Oracle Database, PL/SQL, SQL Server, Microsoft Azure DevOps (TFS), SQL Serve, Web Technologies and Architectures (REST, JSON, XML, SOAP, HTTP), Linux, JavaScript, Python, Jira, Git, SVN, Docker.

Work Experience

Software Engineer – R&D

PaySolutions - Vancouver, Canada, February 2019 – Present

- Led development of two separate **third party interface development projects** for two of our biggest clients with Workday and ADP, which were completed on time with **45% cost reduction**.
- Automated error handling process of our **restful API services** that reduced one of our clients support ticket rate by 80%.
- Designed and developed the new **W4 interfaces** for our existing US-based clients to provide **seamless tax withholding experience** with their payroll (Workday, UltiPro, ADP, Kronos, WFR, Infinity HR) system.
- Redesigned the **SAP Concur interface** for our biggest client that benefitted them by **performance improvement of more than 300%**.
- Trained Developers and peer reviewed code to maintain company and industry standard.
- Technologies: Java, Oracle Database, PL/SQL, Postman, T-SQL, MS SQL Server, Azure DevOps (TFS), SQL Server Studio Management, Git.

Software Engineer – Customer Success

PaySolutions - Vancouver, Canada, June 2017 – February 2019

- Created troubleshooting tools that improved support **team's efficiency by more than 30%**.
- Designed and developed **the data receiving module** of the mass transaction uploader platform which is used to pre-process and clean data before generating transaction files.
- Developed **the data restriction feature** of the compensation reporting tool which enabled clients to generate their own customized reports.
- Technologies/ Frameworks: PL/SQL Developer, SQL, JavaScript, Oracle database, Git, SVN, HTML, CSS, Jira.

Intern

Nokia, Helsinki, Finland, April 2016 – May 2017

- Monitored and instantaneously **categorized user's behavior** using different clustering algorithms (Gaussian Mixture Models (GMMs), K-Means).
- Identified the direction and the speed of change of customers from one cluster to another to create and hypothesize **behavior trajectory** for predicting customer behavioral changes.
- Technologies: R, R Studio.

Software Engineer

GraphTL, Bangalore, India, November 2012 – May 2014

- Automated the **testing of various web** app using SoapUI and TestComplete.
- Technologies: JavaScript, Perl, SoapUI, Jira, TestLink.

Education and Certifications

- **M.Sc. Computer Science**, LMU University of Munich, Munich, Germany.
- **B.Sc. Computer Science**, BIT Bangalore Institute of Technology, Bangalore.

Analysis of the resume

This resume is a decent one to start with—however, it can be further improved.

The good

- **A one-page resume.** This person had around five-six years' experience, and they managed to fit the key parts onto one page.
- **Mentioning results and numbers.** The resume had specifics, like the percentage of reducing the client ticket support rate or performance improvements.
- **Good amount of personal details.** This resume doesn't share too many unnecessary personal details.
- **A decent template and usage of bullet points.** The template helps with good usage of space, and bullet points make it easy to read the statements.

Improvement areas

- **Missing location** on the resume. When no address is listed, recruiters might assume the person is out of the country. This was not the case with this person; they were based in Vancouver, Canada. So why not list it?
- **Technologies dumped one after the other.** While it's good to list all technologies this person is proficient with, the formatting and the order could be better. Focus on languages and frameworks that are needed for the position, or that this person wants to call out specifically.
- **Too much bolding.** Much of the bolding is distracting, and some of it makes little sense. Why are all the technical skills in bold? Why are some of the results bolded out? Why are "W4 forms" bolded? Though the person writing the resume probably wanted to be helpful, they draw attention to the wrong areas.
- **Could use more specifics.** Though there are specifics for some bullet points, others could use more details. Take the statement "*Created troubleshooting tools that improved support team's efficiency by more than 30%*". What languages or frameworks did this person use for the tools? Did they come up with an idea? Did they lead a team? How many customers used the tools?
- **Grammar.** Some of the sentences don't read naturally: using a grammar checker would have surfaced these. Taking the previous example: "*Created troubleshooting tools that improved **the** support team's efficiency by more than 30%*".
- **Education dates are missing.** As a hiring manager and a recruiter, not seeing education dates is confusing. Did the person graduate? If so, why not add the dates? If they did not, why don't they mention that they dropped out?
- **Dates could be better placed.** Moving the dates to the right side would make them much easier to scan on the first glance.
- **Docx format.** The original resume was a docx. Using PDFs is a much better choice.

The refactored resume

Technical Skills

- Java, JavaScript, Python, SQL
- Oracle Database, PL/SQL, SQL Server, Microsoft Azure, SQL Server, Git, Docker, REST
- DevOps, web technologies and architectures, data structures and algorithms

Work Experience

Software Engineer R&D team	PaySolutions Vancouver, Canada	Feb 2019 - Present
• Reduced operation costs by 45% for a client by developing third party interfaces using Java, Workday and ADP. • Reduced support tickets by 80% for a large client by automating error handling on their restful API • Improved workflow efficiency by 300% for a client after I redesigned the client's SAP Concur interface • Shipped a next-generation tax withholding experience, integrating with Workday and several other payroll systems. • Trained 5 developers on coding practices and contributed to the company-wide code review guide.		
Software Engineer Customer Success team	PaySolutions Vancouver, Canada	2017 - Feb 2019
• Led a team of 3 to ship a compensation reporting tool, rolling it out to 15 different clients. • Reduced the time to generate data transaction files from 5 minutes to a few seconds by designing, implementing and rolling out the mass transactions uploader platform. • Improved the support team's throughput by 30% by building troubleshooting tools using Javascript.		
Intern	Nokia Helsinki, Finland	2016 - 2017
• Built a real-time user behaviour monitoring system that used several different clustering algorithms like (Gaussian Mixture Models (GMMs) and K-Means. • Predicted customer behavioral changes by identifying the direction and the speed of change of customers from one cluster to another. I created and hypothesized behavior trajectory using R and R Studio.		
Software Engineer	GraphTL Bangalore, India	2012 - 2014
• Reduced regressions by 60% after I automated the testing of our web apps using SoapUI and TestComplete, building tests with Javascript and Perl.		

Education and Certifications

- **M.Sc. Computer Science**, LMU University of Munich, Munich, Germany. **2010 - 2012**
- **B.Sc. Computer Science**, BIT Bangalore Institute of Technology, Bangalore. **2007 - 2010**

Analysis of the refactored resume

The refactored resume addressed all the above improvement areas, and the person ended up with more calls and an offer with a local startup. The main improvements from the original resume were:

- **Mentioning their location** as Vancouver, Canada and not omitting it, like before.

first, then the technologies relevant for the job that they were proficient in.

- **An easier to scan template** with dates and positions standing out.
- **Starting with the impact of their work** in their work experiences, instead of burying this information deeper.
- **Giving more specifics** on their work experience. For example, they mentioned leading a small team, which they previously left off.
- **Dropping months from older dates**—from four or more years back. It makes the dates easier to scan. This person didn't have a gap in their employment since 2016, and this can make scanning their resume a bit easier.
- **Adding education dates** to add more context on how long they have been doing software development.

Remote Software Engineer With 8 Years Experience

The below resume is a 2-page CV for a senior software engineer based in Europe. This person was primarily targeting remote positions.

The candidate behind this resume struggled to get responses from international companies, even though they were a senior candidate. Following the refactor, their response rate increased dramatically, and they ended up choosing one of the multiple offers they secured.

The original resume



SOFTWARE ENGINEER

+32-20-222-2222
DAN.MITCCH@GMAIL.COM
WARSAW, POLAND

OPEN FOR REMOTE POSITIONS



EDUCATION

WARSAW UNIVERSITY OF
TECHNOLOGY
2007-2011

SYSTEMS DEVELOPMENT



FIND ME

- LINKEDIN
- GITHUB
- HACKERRANK



OTHERSKILLS

- ISTQB-CERTIFIED TESTER
- LEADERSHIP
- SOURCE CONTROL, ETC.
- CAT. B DRIVING LICENSE



EXPERIENCE

- **ERICSSON COMMUNICATIONS** 2012-2013
SOFTWARE DEVELOPER
TEST RESPONSIBLE
- **TTL LLC** 2013-2016
SOFTWARE DEVELOPER
TECHNICAL LEADER
- **SUMO LOGIC** 2016-2018
ENGINEER OF ENGINE TEAM
- **DRIVE LLC** 2019-2020
DEVELOPER, ARCH-DEV TEAM
- **FREELANCER** 2020-



SKILLS

C++
QT
PYTHON
AUTOMATION
NODEJS
CAD/CAM





DETAILED EXPERIENCE

FREELANCER (HOMESHOP TECHNOLOGIES LLC)

2020–

- WORKING AS A FREELANCER IN THE E-COMMERCE INDUSTRY
- MOSTLY DEVELOPING DATA PROCESSING MICROSERVICES RUNNING IN THE CLOUD
- DEVELOPMENT OF A LARGER B2B SOFTWARE USING PYTHON

DRIVE LLC

2019–2020

- DEVELOPER OF ARCH-DEV TEAM
- CUSTOMIZING EXISTING SOLUTIONS TO SPECIALIZED PLATFORMS (NVIDIA DRIVE PX)
- BUILD SCRIPT MAINTENANCE (JENKINS, CMAKE, PYTHON, BASH)
- PERFORMANCE AND QUALITY IMPROVEMENTS (C++)
- ARCHITECTURE DESIGN

SUMO LOGIC

2016–2018

- DEVELOPMENT OF THE MULTIPLATFORM GRAPHICAL ENGINE (C++11 AND 14)
- UNIT TESTING (GTEST)
- BUILD SCRIPT MAINTENANCE (JENKINS, CMAKE, PYTHON, BASH)
- ENGINE INTEGRATION TO PLATFORM APPLICATIONS (TYPESCRIPT, OBJECTIVE-C, JAVA)
- GIVING A HELPING HAND IN QA PROCESS DESIGN

TTL LLC

2013–2016

- DEVELOPMENT OF LINE-FIT NAVIGATION SOLUTIONS (C++, LUA, PLATFORMS: WINCE AND ANDROID)
- TECHNICAL LEADERSHIP OF DEVELOPMENT PROJECTS (COMMUNICATION WITH CUSTOMERS AND INTERNAL TEAMS)
- CODE BRANCH AND BUILD ENVIRONMENT MANAGEMENT (SVN, TEAMCITY)

ERICSSON COMMUNICATIONS

2012–2013

- WEB DEVELOPMENT AS INTERN (PHP, JAVASCRIPT, JQUERY)
- TEST AND BUILD ENVIRONMENT AUTOMATION AS TEST RESPONSIBLE (HIT, BASH, QT, SVN AND GIT)
- FAULT CORRECTION AND GENERAL SOFTWARE DEVELOPMENT (TNSDL AND C)
- TOOL DEVELOPMENT (BASH, QT, C++)

Analysis of the resume

I was not surprised to see that this person barely received calls from recruiters. This resume did an excellent job in breaking several unwritten CV "rules" and downplaying the candidate's experience.

The good

- **Not much good to say** about this resume, beyond the fact that the person behind the resume has a *lot* of experience to build on. Let's jump instead to the biggest improvement areas.

page - however, the second page contains most of their "proper" experience.

- **Photo** that introduces bias. Just remove it.
- **Irrelevant skills listed.** Leadership? Cat-B driving license for a remote developer job? Remove these.
- **Skills with 1-5 points** make it seem like this person is a poor engineer. They rate themselves 4 stars at most, and one star on Node.JS. Talking to this person, they were an expert or proficient on most technologies. I advised them to remove the rating altogether.
- **Reverse chronological work experience.** On the first page, the oldest experience is listed first. This is both confusing and shows this person is unaware of resume basics.
- **Only talking about "what" they did, not the results.** The resume does not use active language, and does not do a good job describing the results this person delivered.

The refactored resume

E-MAIL: garattucci@gmail.com

LINKEDIN

GITHUB

Skills**Languages and technologies**

- Expert in Python and C++ and a wide variety of frameworks for these languages, for example: Flask, Selenium, Numpy, Qt5, Boost, POCO
- Experienced with a number of CI systems, testing frameworks and designing/running services in a cloud-based architecture
- Familiar with designing and using multiple database systems, for example SQL, NoSQL databases
- Familiar with a number of other programming languages, for example: JavaScript, Java, TypeScript and C#
- Proficient in API and architecture design, experienced in technical and team leadership
- ISTQB Foundations certified software tester, experienced in TDD
- English (C1 level certification by TELC Hungary)

Education

Engineer of Computer Sciences, BSC at Warsaw University of Technology and Economics, graduated in 2011.

Work experience**Freelancer****Homeshop Technologies**

2020 spring -

- Creating backend microservices for customers operating in the e-commerce market to implement automated business solutions
- Up to 10 times increase in store throughput in some cases, with up to 50% decrease in manual labor requirements
- Technologies used: Python (with Flask, Selenium and Numpy), C++ (with Qt framework), Linux and Cloud architecture development, JavaScript, git, CMake and qmake

Developer, Arch-Dev Team**Drive LLC**

2019 summer - 2020 spring

- Architecture design and software development to create production/demo ready solutions from research findings for self-driving vehicles
- Increased performance of stereo-camera lane detector solution by 100%, enabling it to run on an nVidia Drive PX2 or Jetson embedded hardware with acceptable reaction time in less than 2 weeks
- Technologies used: C++ (14), Qt, Python, CMake, nVidia SDKs, git

Sabbatical break

2018 winter - 2019 summer

- Studying Python through smaller projects and learning how to operate and maintain 3-axis CNC mills

Engineer of Engine Team**Sumo Logic**

2016 - 2018 winter

- Application developer responsible for developing new features and maintaining the multi-platform graphics engine of the company
- Completely refactored the network interface of the engine on all platforms to move resource procession to the cloud, resulting in a 20-100% decrease in load times
- Technologies used: C++ (11 and 14), GTest, Python, CMake, Jenkins, Java, Objective-C, TypeScript and JavaScript, git, emscripten, OpenGL (ES 2.0), WebGL

Technical Leader (senior)**TTL LLC.**

2015 - 2016

- Technical leadership of multiple line-fit navigation software solution projects
- Successfully negotiated and managed the technical and scheduling details between clients, 3rd-party

LINKEDIN	GITHUB
vendors and other departments of the company	
Delivered the first SCOOP integration with a GUI	
Technical Leader	TTL LLC. 2014 – 2015
- Technical leadership of a line-fit navigation software solution project - Refactored the software development process in order to deliver the product on deadline, without any open customer issues and overtime – a first in the company's history (and with over 4 million licenses sold) - Technologies used: C++, Python, TeamCity, subversion	
Software Developer	TTL LLC. 2013 – 2014
- Feature development and maintenance on an automotive line-fit navigation software product - Successfully designed and implemented multiple communication interfaces (including speech recognition interface with 3rd-party vendor) - Technologies used: C++, Python, TeamCity, subversion	
Test Lead	Ericsson Communications 2012 – 2013
- Planned and scheduled functional tests, mentored junior test engineers on trainings and one-on-one basis - Sped up the provocative test case creation process via automation, reducing development time for customer case test cases by 40–80% - Technologies used: Bash, PowerShell, C, TNSDL, C++, Qt	
Software Engineer	Ericsson Communications 2011 – 2012
- Manual and automated testing - Developed and tested the implementation of multiple LTE features (VoLTE features through SIP protocol)	
Intern	Ericsson Communications 2011 winter
- Web-based tool development - Technologies used: JavaScript, HTML, CSS, Bash, MySQL	

Analysis of the refactored resume

The refactored resume performed far better. This person heard back from companies who ignored their previous resume. They did well on multiple interviews and had several offers to choose from in a matter of weeks.

There's always room for improvement, though, and I would still suggest the following changes to make this CV even stronger:

- **More consistent formatting** as a whole. The spacing and bullet points have a strange layout.
- **Date formatting** could be cleaner. Using seasons is fine for e.g. internships ("summer 2011), but instead of "2019 summer - 2020 spring", "Jun 2019 - Mar 2020" reads more clear.
- **Use active language.** Instead of "Creating backend microservices...", say "Created backend microservices..."

their work experience.

- **Consider using a better template or a resume template service** like Standard Resume for a more professional layout. This person went alone with the template, customizing it themselves. It still feels very DIY, and resume layout is not their strength.

SRE Engineer with 20 Years Experience

The resume is from a systems admin working in a high performance computing environment, who holds a PhD. They have been happily employed for over 10 years at their current workplace. Their original resume was just adding details of the last 10 years' employment to the same resume they used when applying in 2010.

Following the refactor, this person saw a good amount of interest. They ended up getting and accepting an SRE offer - exactly the position they were after.

The original resume

Address: 163 Dourn Road, London SW6, UK
Phone: +441 23 2456789
Email: sam.smith_@gmail.com

PERSONAL PROFILE

Extensive Linux Systems Administration experience, with 10+ years in a High Performance Computing environment.

Network and systems administration of multiple large compute clusters, including taking the systems from design and tender, through to physical installation, software stack, provisioning, management and maintenance. Monitoring, performance analysis, and working at scale are core parts of current role.

Deployment of physical and virtual servers and services, including high availability services.
Management and monitoring of private cloud infrastructure.

Excellent communication, interpersonal and technical writing skills, backed up with IT training certifications and extensive IT training experience.

Code development in multiple languages.

Have a proven interest in learning new technologies, languages and systems. Completed a 1 year full-time Taught Masters in HPC while working full-time in systems administration.

KEY SKILLS

Operating Systems

- Linux: RHEL, Centos, Ubuntu (strong)
- PaaS, IaaS, Cloud & Virtualisation (strong)
- Windows Server & Active Directory (prior experience)

Training & Customer Support

- Problem-solving and troubleshooting of the 'full stack': hardware, middleware, software
- Excellent interpersonal skills
- Training course design and delivery
- Technical writing

Programming Languages

- C, Perl, Bash (strong)
- Python, PHP (proficient)
- Go, Java, JavaScript (basic)

Technologies

- Core networking: TCP/IP, DNS, DHCP, HTTP, TLS, Firewalls
- LAMP stack
- Orchestration using Puppet, Ansible, Salt
- Monitoring via Prometheus, ELK, Nagios, Cacti
- High availability: HAProxy, Keepalived
- Virtualisation using OpenNebula, KVM, Ceph.
- Git and basic CI/CD

CAREER SUMMARY

Senior Systems Administrator TPC, University College London, Bloomsbury, London, UK
Feb 2010 – Present

- Design, installation, management, maintenance and monitoring of multiple high performance Linux compute clusters, networking, SAN storage.
- Team lead since Nov 2012.
- Manage 300+ physical Linux servers across three data centres.
- Infrastructure as code (physical, virtual) using deployment and orchestration technologies such as PXE, Kickstart, Puppet, Ansible, Salt. Canary deployments for node upgrades.
- Systems monitoring using Prometheus, ELK, Nagios, Cacti and custom health check scripts.
- Security and user management including LDAP database provision and maintenance.
- Automated deployment of TLS certs using Let's Encrypt and HAProxy.
- Resource management and scheduling on compute clusters, including development of multiple custom add-ons to scheduler.
- Provision of research support to researchers from multiple disciplines, and to the community in general through online documentation and training.
- Liaising directly with research groups, advising on hardware and software requirements.

Page 1 of 2

- Design, development and delivery of training courses.
- Teaching of programming and software skills.
- Liaising with vendors and service providers.
- Active participation in research projects in web development & CMS deployment.
- Collaborate on cross-functional projects within the larger IT unit.

Co-Founder and Trainer **researchlab**, 4 Rock Drive, London, UK
Oct 2008 – Dec 2009

- Set up a new IT training business focused on designing and delivering bespoke, high-quality, high-impact training to organisations.
- Delivered training to individuals and teams from numerous Irish/multinational organisations, including blue-chip IT companies and government departments/agencies.

Senior Training Consultant **Tents Ltd**, St Johns, London, UK
Jan 2004 – Sep 2008

- Provided in-house training and supervision to junior training staff.
- Researched both existing and new IT topics, developing course-ware and training materials.
- Delivered training to individuals and teams from numerous Irish/multinational organisations, including blue-chip IT companies and government departments/agencies.
- Courses included: MCSA, Linux Admin, Network+, A+, Java, Perl, PHP, JavaScript, Crystal Reports.

Systems Administrator **Futuristic Systems**, Graham House, 150 Upper Thomas's St, Liverpool, UK
June 2000 – Sept 2002

- UNIX and NT systems administration, involving installation and maintenance of PCs, Sun workstations & servers, and switches.

Systems Administrator **The Internet Society**, Liverpool, UK
Sept 1998 – May 2000

- Installation and maintenance of UNIX systems such as Linux PCs and Sun Solaris servers, on a voluntary basis in the student-run college Internet society.

EDUCATION

Postgraduate Degree: **University College London** Oct 2011 – Sep 2012

Masters Degree (Taught) in High Performance Computing, School of Mathematics

Taught masters focusing on practical training in the use of large-scale and multi-core computers for scientific simulation and mathematical modelling. Course work included numerical analysis, parallel programming (MPI), stochastic modelling, Monte Carlo simulation.

Postgraduate Degree: **University College London** Oct 2001 – Dec 2003

Masters Degree (Research) in Computer Science.

Research project focused on WWW Connectivity Analysis, and in particular Web Spider technology. Project work involved Java, SQL, JDBC, Linux, HTML, and HTTP.

Undergraduate Degree: **University College London** Oct 1997 – Jun 2001

Joint Honours Degree (1st class honours) in Computer Science and Mathematics.

IT CERTIFICATIONS

- MCSA on Windows Server 2003
- MCSA on Windows 2000 Server
- Microsoft Certified Professional (MCP)
- ECDL Certified Training Professional (CTP)
- CompTIA Network+
- CompTIA Certified Technical Trainer (CTT+)

Analysis of the resume

technology. Having interacted with the person, I can tell you they are - but their resume does not indicate this.

The good

- **A very experienced candidate.** With a PhD and close to 20 years of professional experience, this candidate has a lot of things to bring to the table.
- **Lots of relevant technologies.** HAProxy, Prometheus, ELK and other technologies they've listed are considered close to cutting edge in 2020. This person clearly keeps up to date or works at a place that moves with the industry.